

Today's Hours

[Home](#) / [News & Events](#) / [Latest Stories](#)

Take a sneak peek into the Creator Commons

Students, staff, and faculty got a chance to explore the newly renovated space

May 15th, 2025

[Skip to Content](#)

Librarian Leanne Nay assists a visitor with a heat press during the Creator Commons Open House 2, 2025.

Interested in VR? What about sewing? Maybe photography, or recording music? No matter your interest, it's likely Creator Commons has something for you.

Students, staff, faculty and more dropped in May 2 for a sneak peek of the newly renovated Creator Commons on the first floor of the West Tower in Herman B Wells Library to explore the space and try the new equipment. From Meta Quest 3s to synthesizers, and sewing machines to 3D printers, there really is something for every student in the Creator Commons.

The space is a collaboration between IU Libraries and University Information Technology Services (UITs). The Creator Commons is larger and has lots of new equipment, but its purpose remains the same as that of the original Wells Library Makerspace and [IUI Idea Garden](#): To offer a beginner-friendly space that removes as many barriers to material and equipment as possible.



A bracelet is scanned by Andy Webb, 3D Lab Coordinator for UITs, with a 3D scanner in the Creator Commons on May 2, 2025.

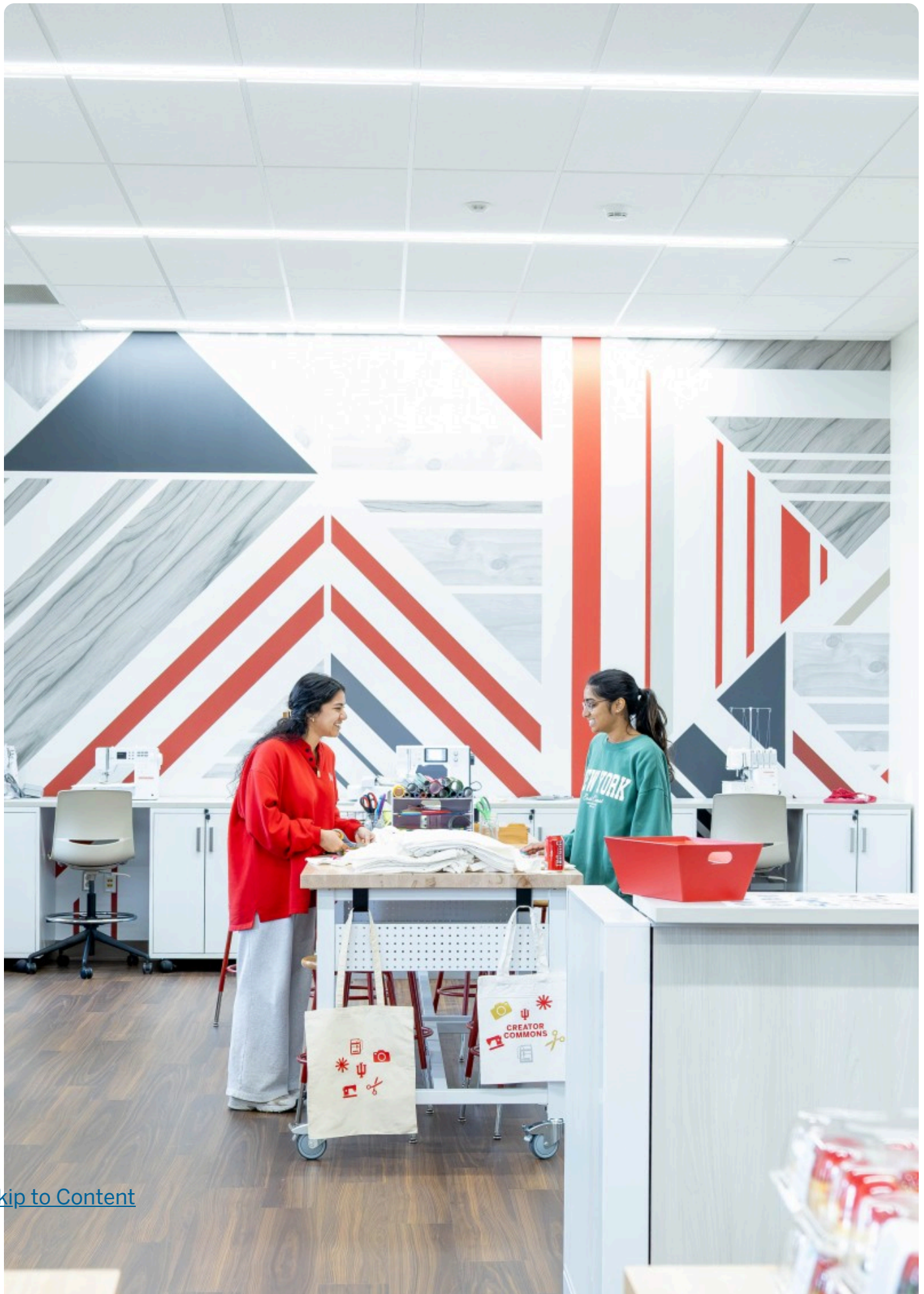
[Skip to Content](#) "The Creator Commons is an expansion of our Wells Library Makerspace," Leanne Nay, Creative Technologies Librarian, said. "We want this to be a creative space where students

can try new things. We want to continue to reach all disciplines, reach all people from across IU, and just bring them into this glorious world of making.”

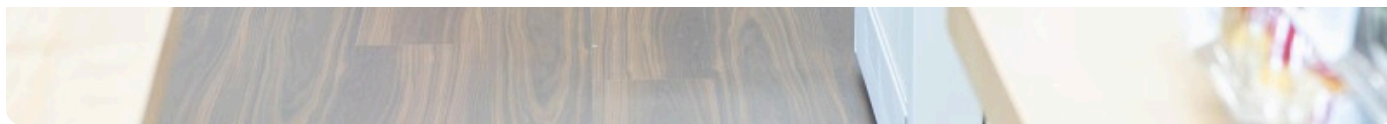
The new space provides a significantly larger place for activities and looks out over the Wells Library patio.

“I think it's going to grow a lot more because of our bigger space,” Nada Abdelrahim, the Creative Instruction and Outreach Librarian, said.

[Skip to Content](#)



[Skip to Content](#)



Students make new creations in the Creator Commons on May 2, 2025.

The expansion of equipment offered isn't limited to items that stay in space. The official opening of the new Creator Commons in the fall will also mean an increase in the number of items that can be checked out by students. For example, instead of having five cameras, there will be closer to 40. Students use the equipment for assignments as well as personal projects.

It means we'll have a better chance of serving more students
and serving this gigantic campus,”

Leanne Nay, Creative Technologies Librarian

[Skip to Content](#)

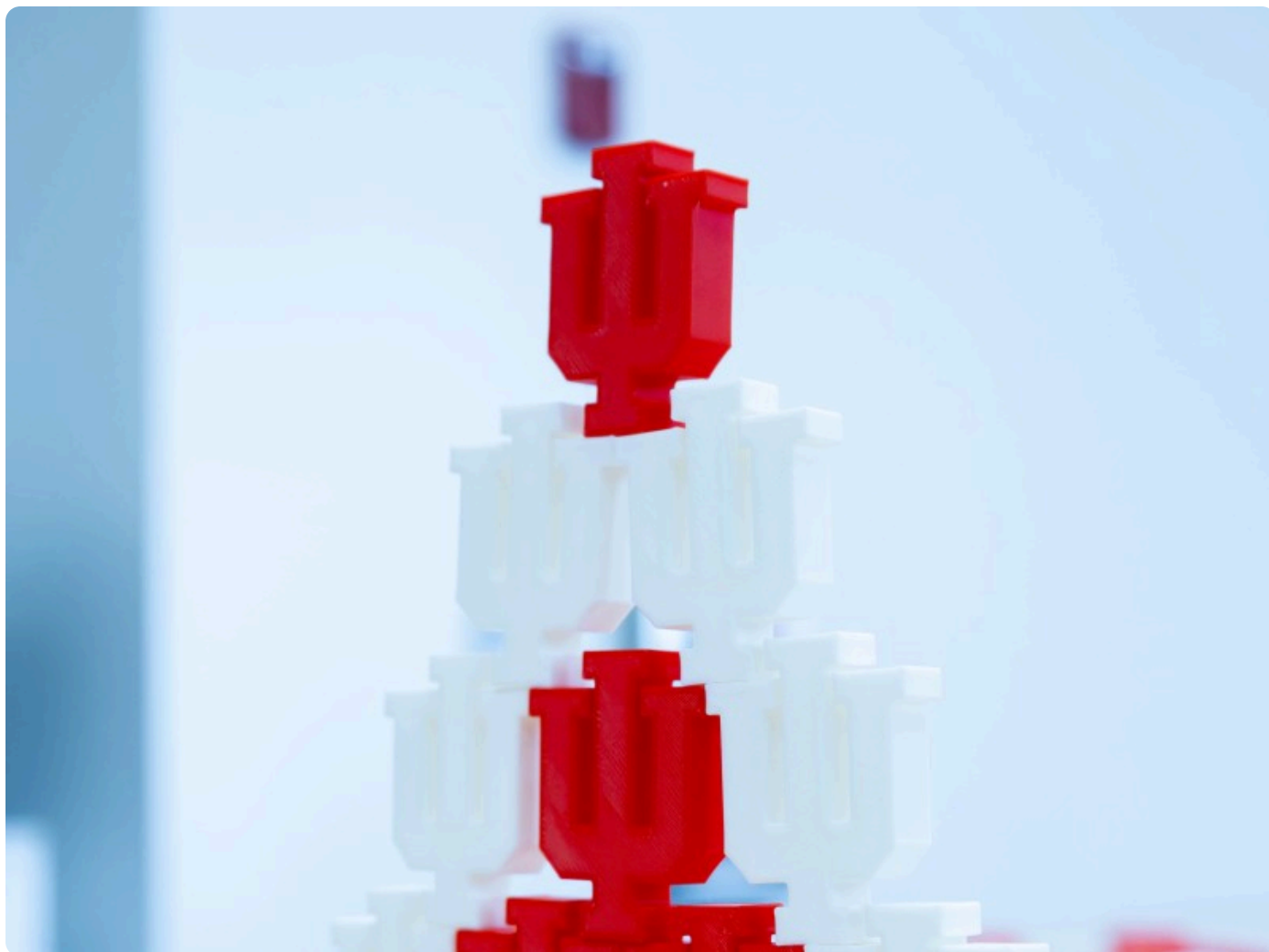


An embroidery machine works on embroidering text reading "Creator Commons" on May 2, 2025, at the Open House for the Creator Commons.

The expansion of the space comes from great enthusiasm from students of all disciplines. Kathryn Thompson, UITs Student Outreach and Engagement Consultant, has discussed emerging technologies with students across the IU campus.

"I've talked to lots of students around campus and they're very excited for this technology. They want more VR, and they want more 3D printing," she said.

[Skip to Content](#)



A stack of 3D printed IU tridents stands in a tower during the Creator Commons Open House on May 2, 2025.

The Creator Commons was one of three spaces recently upgraded at IU Libraries. The renovations totaled 26,350 square feet of improved spaces for research, discovery, and exploration. Most of the \$1.5M renovations were funded thanks to IU Libraries donors.

The other two spaces include the 4th floor of the West Tower; a large area designed for group and individual study. It was finished the week before finals and students swarmed the space for study prior to final exams. Additionally, the Reference Reading Room was transformed from the original 1970's layout and furnishings to a revitalized, modern, and appealing space.

Much like the Creator Commons, the space now highlights the large windows to allow natural light to pour in.

[Skip to Content](#) "It has been a thrill to usher these spaces into more modern and welcoming environments for students and faculty. I hope these reimagined areas inspire users in their learning journey," Amy Cope, the IU Libraries Director of Operations, said.

Preview the equipment you can check out

The Creator Commons will open to students in Fall 2025

Contributors



Authored by

Taylor Burnette

Railsback Fellow 2024-2025



Photography by

Ellie Pursley



Older story:

Dozens of EBSCOHost Databases Updating their Interface

Newer story:

Spotlight: Craig Fellow Olivia Ligman



[Skip to Content](#)



Featured Databases

OneSearch@IU
Google Scholar
JSTOR
WorldCat
Nexis Uni
HathiTrust Digital Library

Databases A-Z

IU Libraries

Reservable Spaces
Our Team
Our Departments
Contact Us
Intranet SharePoint (Staff)
Website Login (Staff)

Give Now

[Skip to Content](#)

Accessibility
College Scorecard
Open to All
Privacy Notice

